

KIP THORNE AND RAINER WEISS

Born 1940 and 1932

Kip Thorne predicted the existence of wormholes, and also calculated that black holes can produce ripples in space – just as a stone dropped in a pond makes ripples in the water. Rainer Weiss devised the Laser Interferometer Gravitational-Wave Observatory (LIGO), which, in 2016, picked up the ripples from two colliding black holes.

DATA FILE



KEY DISCOVERY: Identified and observed gravitational waves



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: United States



YEAR OF DISCOVERY: 2016

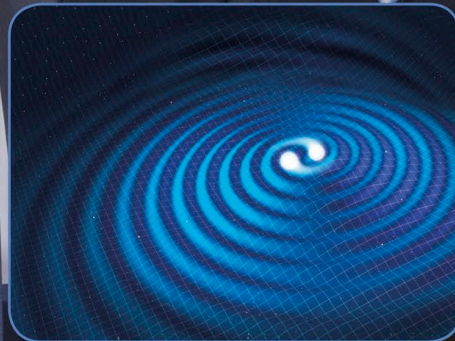


Rainer Weiss

LIGO can measure ripples one-billionth the size of an atom.



Kip Thorne



Artist's impression of gravitational waves